visionary women leaders on the council, such as Maud Olofsson, former Deputy Prime Minister of Sweden; Sri Mulyani Indrawati, former Finance Minister of Indonesia; Sheikha Lubna bint Khalid bin Sultan Al Qasimi, Minister of Development of the UAE; Wanda Engel Aduan, former Minister of Social Assistance of Brazil; Judith Rodin, President of the Rockefeller Foundation; Melanne Verveer, former US Ambassador-at-Large for Global Women's Issues; and Cherie Blair, among others.

In December 2013, after 30 years in banking, I stepped down from my role in RBS to devote my time fully to public service. I joined the AAP and was their candidate for South Mumbai in the 2014 Lok Sabha elections. The PortLands formed the core agenda of my 2014 Lok Sabha campaign. I promised that irrespective of the outcome of the elections, I would work tirelessly to ensure that polluting activities in this area were stopped and that the PortLands were redeveloped in a manner that would benefit the citizens of Mumbai and not rapacious builders or politicians.

I am happy that I have succeeded in placing the PortLands high on the agenda of both the state and Central governments. I filed a Public Interest Litigation (PIL) case against the Port Trust and the Pollution Control Board to stop the dumping of coal. In a landmark judgement, the Mumbai High Court pulled up the authorities and the Mumbai Port Trust (MbPT) finally committed in court in 2016 that they would stop dumping coal and clean up this area. MbPT also orally agreed to phase out further shipbreaking activities. Today, this area, a source of terrible pollution for the past 10 years, is turning into a clean and green space.

To work on the redevelopment of the PortLands we formed a group called A PortLands Initiative (APLI) Mumbai, consisting of urban planners, architects, bankers, educationists, doctors, engineers and naval officers, among others. Working in partnership with the MbPT, we have brought our professional expertise to help design and conceptualize several projects that will make life easier and more